Class 10 SST - Chapter 4: The Age of Industrialisation

🌟 Introduction to the Chapter

When we think of industrialization, we usually associate it entirely with factories, machines, and mass production. However, this chapter highlights that industrialization actually began long before the first factories were even built, a phase known as proto-industrialization.

📌 Before the Industrial Revolution

Proto-industrialization: This refers to the preliminary phase of industrialization where massive amounts of large-scale production took place for the international market, but it was *not* based on factories.

- **The Process:** Merchants successfully supplied money to local peasants and artisans in the countryside to brilliantly produce goods for them.
- **The Reason:** Urban crafts and trade guilds tightly controlled urban production, forcing merchants explicitly to move seamlessly to the countryside.

The Coming Up of the Factory

The earliest factories in England successfully came up in the 1730s. The most dynamic industries were cotton and metals.

- A series of massive inventions in the 18th century increased the efficacy of each step of the production process (carding, twisting, spinning, and rolling).

- Richard Arkwright famously created the cotton mill.

⚡ Industrialisation in the Colonies: India

India was the largest producer of cotton textiles natively before the age of machine industries.

- **The Decline:** With the coming of the British factory industry, Indian textiles successfully faced massive competition.
- **The Gomasthas:** The East India Company elegantly appointed paid servants called *gomasthas* to properly supervise weavers, collect supplies, and strictly examine cloth quality, explicitly cutting off their links gracefully with other buyers.

Factories Come to India

- **1854:** The first cotton mill came up smartly in Bombay.
- **1855:** The first jute mill effectively came up comfortably in Bengal.

❌ Common Mistakes to Avoid

> [!WARNING]
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> 1. **Hand Labour vs Steam Power:** Do not assume everyone wanted machines immediately. In Victorian Britain, human labor was abundant and cheap. Many industrialists preferred hand labor over expensive machines, especially for highly seasonal industries.
> 2. **Proto-industrialization:** It was not a primitive stage; it was part of a complex network of commercial exchanges controlled by merchants.

Quick Revision

The Peculiarities of Industrial Growth

European Managing Agencies dominated industrial production in India, focusing heavily on products meant for export (like tea, coffee, indigo, and jute) rather than the domestic market. Later, Indian entrepreneurs began setting up their own industries, actively shifting from yarn to cloth production during the Swadeshi movement.